

What is ASHAMitra? — In Simple Words

A plain-language handout: who the ASHA is, what she does, the problems she faces, how ASHAMitra helps, every feature, and the effect on mother & baby health.



Who is an ASHA?

ASHA = the **village health helper** — a trained local woman who is the first health worker for about **1,000 villagers**. Mothers, babies, and children are her main responsibility. She is the **bridge between the village and the hospital**.



What is ASHAMitra?

A **mobile app that becomes her digital assistant**. It replaces her big pile of paper notebooks with one simple app on her own phone — and it quietly watches for danger so she never misses a sick mother or baby.



What does an ASHA do all day? (her tasks)

- Visit **pregnant women** and check they are safe.
- Visit **newborns and small children**, look for danger signs.
- Make sure **vaccines** happen on time.
- Track **growth** (weight, malnutrition).
- **Refer** sick people to the hospital.
- Fill **15+ paper registers** and write a **monthly report** by hand.



Her big problems

1. **Too much paperwork** — she writes the same details again and again in many notebooks.
2. **"Double-double" work** — she writes during the visit, then copies it all again at night.
3. **Danger gets missed** — a warning sign sits hidden in a notebook for weeks, until "reporting day."
4. **No follow-up** — she refers a mother to the hospital... and never finds out if she went.



How ASHAMitra makes her work easy

- She **speaks in Bengali**, the app writes it down — visit notes drop from **~30 minutes to ~5 minutes**.
 - The **monthly report writes itself** from the visits she already did (no more 2 nights of copying).
 - The app **checks for danger automatically** and tells her clearly: ● fine · ● see a clinic · ● emergency, refer now.
 - It **remembers every due date** for her, so nothing is forgotten.
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The features (in easy words)

FEATURE	WHAT IT DOES (SIMPLE)	EXAMPLE
 Aadhaar QR scan	She points the camera at the Aadhaar card; the app fills in name, age, gender, address by itself.	No typing long names by hand — and fewer spelling mistakes.
 Bengali voice	She talks to the app in her own language; it understands and can reply by voice. And the whole app uses the everyday words she actually says — BP, vaccine, checkup, "Overdue" — not textbook Bengali.	Even if typing is hard, she can just <i>speak</i> — and every screen reads the way she talks.
 Danger-sign check (triage)	Asks a few simple questions, checks vitals, and gives a colour: green / yellow / red.	A newborn with fever instantly shows  "refer to SNCU now."
 Child growth check	It compares the child's weight to the WHO standard for that exact age and warns if the child is underweight/severely underweight or not gaining weight since the last visit; it also checks the right development milestones for the age.	A 9-month-old below the safe weight line shows a warning → refer for nutrition care.
 Auto schedule	From the pregnancy date (LMP) or baby's birth date, it builds all the visit dates — ANC check-ups, vaccines, newborn (HBNC) and child (HBYC) visits.	She never has to calculate "when is the next visit."
 Reminders by SMS + WhatsApp	Before each due date, the app messages the mother automatically.	A mother gets a WhatsApp/SMS: " <i>Your ANC check-up is due in 3 days.</i> "
 Auto monthly report (HMIS)	The government monthly report builds itself from her visits; she just reviews it.	2 evenings of copying → a 10-minute check.
 Mother & Child card (PDF)	One tap fills and prints the real government Mother & Child Protection (MCP) card — the family page, the ANC check-up grid , and the full vaccine schedule with the date each dose was given — showing only the pages that fit the case (mother or child).	The same card as the paper booklet, already filled in from her visits.
 Referral + map	When she refers someone, it suggests the right hospital, shows road directions , and later tracks the outcome .	She finally learns: did the mother reach the hospital or not?

FEATURE	WHAT IT DOES (SIMPLE)	EXAMPLE
 Works offline	The danger-check works without internet , in a hut with no signal.	No network? Triage still works.
 Smart alerts	A red (emergency) case alerts her and her supervisor instantly.	Danger is seen <i>today</i> , not on reporting day.

How this helps mother & baby health

- **Danger caught early.** High-risk pregnancies are flagged **from the very first check-up** — not discovered too late.
- **The two biggest mother-killers watched closely: heavy bleeding after delivery (PPH) and fits from high blood pressure (eclampsia)** trigger an **immediate "refer now."**
- **Newborns protected.** *Any* fever, trouble feeding, or breathing problem in a baby = instant red flag → rushed to newborn care, where minutes matter.
- **Malnutrition caught at the village.** The arm-band (MUAC) **plus weight-for-age plus "not gaining since last time"** flag underweight and faltering children early — so nutrition help starts *before* it becomes severe.
- **No missed vaccines.** Daily reminders + a defaulter list mean fewer children fall through the cracks — and the child's whole vaccine card, with dates, prints in one tap.
- **Referrals actually complete.** Tracking shows *why* mothers don't reach hospitals (transport, cost, family) so the real problem can be fixed.
- **Reliable, on time, with proof** — the things that were *supposed* to happen on paper now actually happen, every time, recorded.

In one line: ASHAMitra turns the ASHA's pile of notebooks into a smart helper that does the writing, remembers every date, messages mothers, and never lets a danger sign go unseen — so more mothers and babies get help in time.